



NEWS

New Faculty - Fall 2023

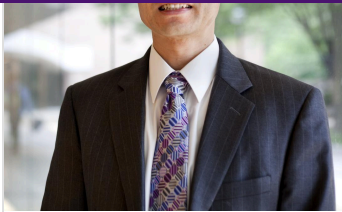
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We take great pride in being a school whose faculty has included such luminaries as Herman Mark, known as the “Father of Polymer Science,” and Ernst Weber, who did pioneering work with microwaves. We take equal pride in our newest faculty members, who are making notable strides in a wide variety of areas and are poised to contribute to the Tandon legacy in their own ways.

New Leadership:

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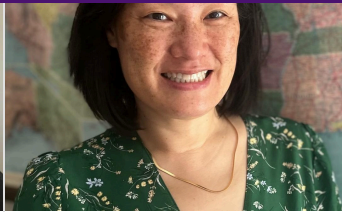
**Katsuo
Kurabayashi**

Chair of
Mechanical and
Aerospace
Engineering



**Nizar
Touzi**

Chair of
Finance and
Risk
Engineering



**Linda
Boyle**

Vice Dean of
Research

New Faculty:

- [Salim Arfaoui](#)
- [Rupak Chatterjee](#)
- [Craig Fahner](#)
- [David Fouhey](#)
- [Radoslav Fulek](#)
- [Michael Hanna](#)
- [Robert Krueger](#)
- [Dharik Mallapragada](#)
- [Yuzhang Lin](#)
- [Hamed Rahmani](#)
- [Austin Rovinski](#)
- [Anton Rozhkov](#)
- [Erdem Varol](#)
- [Takahiro Yabe](#)
- [Sai Zhang](#)

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edge research while testing quantum algorithms out on actual quantum computers.” (Chatterjee’s interests also extend into the realm of quantum gravity, where topics such as the quantum entanglement of curved space time regions are being explored.)

And as far as what else he’s looking forward to once he’s settled in at NYU: “I played the tenor sax in a band before the pandemic,” he explains, “and I know the jazz scene in Brooklyn is very good.”

Craig Fahner

Assistant Professor, Technology, Culture and Society



Visiting Assistant Professor [Craig Fahner](#) makes artworks that question and reimagine the way that media technologies shape everyday life.

Take Zoom, for example, the meeting platform that has become a ubiquitous

part of life for many since the advent of the COVID-19 pandemic. What social impact does it have? What might an alternative version aimed at soothing users and allowing them to experience togetherness in a new way?



platform incorporates an in-browser facial feature tracker that detects when a participant has closed their eyes, at which point, an audible tone is produced. When multiple users are simultaneously using the site and closing their eyes, distinct tones are produced for each, resulting in an organ-like collaborative instrument. Fahner writes: "Serving as a sanctuary away from the non-stop stream of information afforded by typical platforms, this project encourages users to slow down and, through deep listening, appreciate a meditative moment shared with others, rendered as a drifting drone of harmonized tone." Musical collaboration, he stresses, can serve as a model by which we might think about the way we communicate online.

Fahner, who will be teaching in Tandon's Integrated Design & Media program, is interested in researching the affective dimensions of digital media, whether that is the calm of *Eigengrau* and the whispering voices on autonomous sensory meridian response (ASMR) videos or the "comforting rage" (a term coined by new-media scholar Wendy Hui Kyong Chun) felt by those caught in the sway of online political screeds.

The emotional dimensions of online information influence us even when that information is untrue, says Fahner, who is a co-investigator in the Data Fluencies project based out of Simon Fraser University's Digital Democracies Institute. "We *want* to be distracted and entranced when we are scrolling on social media feeds," he explains. "So it's easy to fall down internet rabbit holes and allow disinformation to take root."

develop critical digital literacy — in effect, fighting the algorithm as young people of past decades espoused “fighting the power.” He wants to make transparent the invisible ways we are influenced as we go about our daily lives via algorithmic media — even down to the movies we see and restaurants we patronize thanks to recommendation algorithms.

That concept of visualizing the invisible has resonated with Fahner since his formative years, when he was involved in Calgary’s alternative music scene and was invited to play the theremin in a band known as The Ostrich (which one can find on the internet if you dig deeply enough). “The theremin makes the player part of the circuit and allows you to feel sound waves you can’t see,” he explains. “They’re still invisible, but now they’re tactile. That got me interested in how technology could be harnessed to articulate invisible aspects of the environment, whether that involves radio waves or digital infrastructures.”

David Fouhey

Assistant Professor, Electrical and Computer Engineering

It would be difficult for Assistant Professor of Electrical and Computer Engineering [David Fouhey](#) to ever have a boring day at work — not when that work involves astronomy, zoology, robotics, and multiple other topics.